

KEVIN ZHU

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EXPERIENCE

SCHONFELD

Senior Software Engineer – Applied AI Solutions

New York, NY
Jan 2025 – Present

- Grew Schonfeld’s AI platform from a basic chatbot into a firm-wide ecosystem used daily by **>80% of employees**
- Architected a distributed ingestion and retrieval platform supporting **2M+** documents on **OpenSearch** and LlamaIndex with hash-based delta ingestion; reduced incremental sync **from hours to minutes** at **10x lower cost** than Kendra
- Designed Prefect-based orchestrator with short-lived Kubernetes worker pods for elastic horizontal scaling; introduced per-datasource ingestion manifests controlling chunking strategy, embedding model and sync schedules—reducing new datasource onboarding **from days to minutes** and improving retrieval recall from **~75% to 95%+**
- Designed and launched **RAG**-based chatbot framework using LiteLLM, OpenAI, Bedrock and Kendra—enabling any team to deploy agentic AI assistants without engineering support
- Serve as the firm’s internal AI authority, advising teams on agentic workflow design, evaluations and AI safety; lead company-wide enablement sessions for **executives, traders, analysts and quants**

Software Engineer – Applied AI Solutions

June 2023 – Jan 2025

- Built firm-wide LLM-powered AI assistant integrating proprietary data sources, automation systems and internal APIs to streamline research and operational workflows
- Pioneered agentic workflows via a function-calling AI assistant for IT support, establishing the architectural foundation for the broader AI platform
- Developed AI-driven automation solutions across research synthesis, risk reporting, legal contract review and recruiting—integrating data from OneNote, Bloomberg, ServiceNow and GitHub
- Implemented real-time AI observability and evaluation framework with Datadog, including latency tracking, clustering-based response analysis and automated failover mechanisms

AMAZON WEB SERVICES (AWS)

Software Development Engineer I – Elastic Compute Cloud (EC2)

Seattle, WA
Mar 2022 – June 2023

- Architected and deployed major upgrade to the **EC2 ReportInstanceStatus API**, adding automated remediation, data analytics and Grafana dashboarding while optimizing for performance and scalability
- Led successful cross-functional effort reducing EC2 server impairment recidivism from 7% to 2%, delivering infrastructure efficiency gains of **>\$10M annually**
- Diagnosed and resolved a long-standing bug generating 42,000 false EC2 maintenance alerts per month, earning internal recognition for **customer obsession**

Software Development Engineer Intern – Elastic Compute Cloud (EC2)

May 2021 – Aug 2021

- Built server health analytics pipeline covering **>4M EC2 instances** and a dashboard to visualize failure signals, reducing new signal onboarding time by **>80%**
- Automated ticket creation for repeat EC2 failures, reducing manual toil and preventing bad hosts from serving customers

EDUCATION

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, BERKELEY

B.A. in Computer Science (GPA: 3.6/4.0)

Tutor & Lab Assistant, CS61C (Computer Architecture)

Berkeley, CA
Dec 2021

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, SQL, TypeScript, HTML/CSS

Frameworks & Tools: OpenAI, Anthropic, MCP, LlamaIndex, LiteLLM, Prefect, Datadog, GitHub Actions, React

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (EC2, S3, DynamoDB, Bedrock, Lambda, Eventbridge, OpenSearch), Terraform

Hobbies & Interests: Film photography, mixology, downhill skiing, grilling meat